Aleksandr Detushev

Lead Game Designer

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Project: Warspear Online ↗ · Google Play ↗ · App Store ↗

Profile

Lead Game Designer with 6+ years of experience on Warspear Online, a live MMORPG with a long-running player base, a 20-class roster, large-scale PvP, and progression-heavy systems. Focused on class design, long-term balance, player-facing progression, guild and social systems, and live content design in a high-investment environment.

Currently leading a team of 3 designers while remaining hands-on with feature direction, system design, documentation, and cross-functional execution. Strong background in systemic design, live balance, and player psychology in games where long-term progression and player trust heavily shape design decisions.

Work Experience

Lead Game Designer

Aigrind — Warspear Online

2022 – Present

- Lead a team of 3 game designers and coordinate their work across live updates, feature ownership, and cross-team delivery.
- Act as the primary design bridge between leadership, product management, engineering, art, UI/UX, and narrative.
- Own and supervise high-impact areas including class balance across a 20-class live MMORPG roster, guild systems, talent systems, raids, events, and repeatable progression content.
- Help shape feature scope, priorities, and implementation logic from concept through release, balancing creative goals with production realities.
- Improve internal design flow through clearer reviews, feedback loops, and cross-department alignment, reducing friction during live production.
- Support balance changes in a monetised progression environment where character investment is high and changes must preserve long-term player trust.

- Contribute directly to systems design, feature structure, gameplay logic, and design documentation while in a leadership role.

Senior Game Designer

Aigrind — Warspear Online
2019 – 2022

- Designed and balanced 4 new playable classes for a 20-class live MMORPG roster.
- Delivered Templar and Chieftain in 2020, then Beastmaster and Reaper in 2022, shaping class identity, skill kits, gameplay roles, and long-term live balance considerations.
- Expanded gameplay diversity and replay value by opening new build paths, role coverage, and stronger class differentiation across the meta.
- Created new equipment and progression demand around fresh classes without undermining existing long-term player investment.
- Led large-scale class rebalance initiatives in a game where progression depth made disruptive balance changes especially sensitive.
- Balanced the introduction of new metas while avoiding unnecessary backlash from nerfs and preserving player trust during class shifts.
- Worked on the Talent System as a long-term progression pillar, increasing build depth, class variety, and recurring engagement opportunities.

Game Designer

Aigrind — Warspear Online
2017 – 2019

- Designed seasonal events and dungeons for a live MMORPG with a regular update cadence.
- Reworked dungeon structure and encounter patterns to reduce repetition across yearly content cycles and keep repeatable content feeling fresher.
- Introduced clearer gameplay patterns, pacing, and encounter variety to improve content readability and perceived novelty over time.
- Prepared implementation-ready design documentation and collaborated closely with programmers and artists to ship content under tight live deadlines.

Selected Systems

Talent System
Worked on a long-term progression system designed to increase build diversity, extend character growth, and create stronger ties between class identity and repeatable content.

Competitive Guild Content
Contributed to guild-focused systems and endgame structures that supported organized play, longer-term goals, and stronger social retention.

Class Ecosystem & Live Balance
Managed class identity and long-term balance in

Live Content Design
Built and iterated on events, dungeons, and

a 20-class live game where player progression depth makes balance changes especially high stakes.

repeatable features within a live production environment with frequent updates and ongoing post-release support.

Skills & Tools

- Class ecosystem design and balance in a 20-class live MMORPG.
- Long-term progression and build diversity systems.
- Guild, social, and repeatable engagement features.
- PvE and PvP systems design for live content.
- Player-trust-aware monetisation thinking.
- Cross-functional leadership in live production.

Tools

- Confluence
- Redmine
- MySQL Workbench
- TortoiseSVN

Languages

- Russian — Native
- English — Working proficiency (comfortable in spoken communication, actively improving)

Education

Saint Petersburg State University of Aerospace Instrumentation (SUAI)

Computer Science (unfinished degree)